

Assignment 3

My summer interning for the Portland Pickles Baseball Team consisted of a well rounded experience filled with teamwork, retail understanding, and fun! The interns would work every single game day, from around noon to 11pm, which totaled to around 220 hours of work. A typical day would consist of setting up the merch tent, trash bags, and cleaning under the bleachers before a quick dinner, and then our roles for the game itself would be announced. I was usually either on the social media team or in the merch tent. I enjoyed working in the merch tent, I learned a lot about sales and how to use a POS, as well as anticipating what customers liked and ordering more merchandise.

Occasionally, I would be put on the 50/50 raffle, where I would have to sell tickets to spectators. I would have to work on my sales pitch, understand when the right and wrong time to ask people if they wanted to buy, and to work the room in order to get the most money possible. I'm proud to say I set the highest record for 50/50 raffle ticket sales with a whopping \$1,200!

Our bosses were very receptive to our needs as students and what we wanted to get out of the internship, so they offered for interns to come in early to learn more about the business side of the organization. I went to the office once to help with making graphics for their food and drink specials of the day, making sure to make the signage very clear and receptive to customers.

The Portland Pickles would have themed nights for all the games, and it was up to the interns to dress up and contribute to that culture as well as provide a seamless baseball experience. I convinced all the interns to wear their cowboy boots and hats to the Wild West Night, which made the overall game experience so much fun for everyone!

I think the Pickles provided such a fun and unique experience for me. Having a summer of sports business under my belt I think will provide great insight and experience for future jobs, regardless if it's in the sports industry or not.

Referencing back to EMPAC, the Pickles used a lot, if not all aspects. For Entertainment, the Pickles are similar to the Savannah Bananas baseball team, focusing more on entertaining spectators through special themes, rowdy regulars, and fun food and drinks. By playing into what consumers are looking for (a fun time), they can hone into more unconventional tactics that "Keep Portland Weird." For Matching and Price, there really isn't that much competition surrounding the Pickles, and I do think they inflate their prices for food and merch during the game, which is what most sports teams do for these items, but while keeping their ticket prices very cheap. For Assortment, I think the Pickles have a wide variety for merch and food, but tend to run out quickly, opting for people to look online or at their stand alone merch store as back ups. Lastly, for Convenience, the Stadium is located in Southeast Portland, which is a pretty central location for people in the greater Portland area. Like mentioned earlier, prices are very accessible and parking is easy to find.

Overall, I am eternally grateful for getting the opportunity to work for the Portland Pickles, an organization that puts the fans first, and brings an authentic, Portland experience to however wants it!